DONALD B. HAVERY

Intelligence Manager

AI Operations · Head of AI · Applied AI and Agent Engineering · AI Cost Optimization and FinOps · Forward Deployed Engineering

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SUMMARY

I am accountable for AI spend and for what it returns. I decide which work goes to a model, which goes to ordinary software, and which stays with a person. I lower what each result costs, build and ship the agents, put guardrails and human approval where the risk is, and report the results in numbers a finance team can check. I have run my businesses this way with full profit-and-loss responsibility, I supervised and trained drivers in regulated freight, and I build the systems myself in Python and TypeScript.

MEASURED RESULTS

- **Spend efficiency.** Ran 164,039 model calls across 1,416 agent sessions in 58 days on one flat-rate plan. 96.5% of input tokens were served from the prompt cache. The plan covered work that would have been billed at about $17,000 at list API prices, or about $142,500 without the cache. These are usage figures from Claude Code's own records, not cash saved.
- **Quality and routing.** On a 71-question test of my live customer-service agent, cut wrong answers from 3 to 0. Of the 23 cases still handed to a person, 21 were policy the business had not yet decided, so I sent them to the owner as decisions to make.
- **Model cost.** Moved a grading step from a premium model to a lower-cost one only after the cheaper model passed a calibration set in which about half the answers are built to fail.
- **Capacity governance.** Cut parallel agents from 20 to 5 after a burst used a five-hour plan allowance in about 90 minutes, and set a per-agent GPU limit so several workloads share one machine without stopping each other.
- **Risk.** Took my production agent offline when it answered questions the business had not decided, and turned it back on only after each new guard was proven by a test that fails without it.

EXPERIENCE

Intelligence Manager and Owner, Independent AI practice and angrynirds web and AI studio Current

Own the AI budget, the model choices, the builds and the results for my businesses. Live site with Stripe checkout and a production customer-service agent.

Spend and efficiency

- Set hard cost limits in production: an output-token cap, a chat-history cap (input tokens are billed), an 8-step limit per run, per-visitor and daily call limits, and a switch that keeps the agent off until it is turned on.
- Use the cheapest path that passes its tests: a flat-rate subscription before metered API calls, local open models before frontier ones, and a stored answer with no model call when retrieval confidence is high.
- Built an agent run budget that prices the next call before making it and stops the run at its cost or step ceiling, and an LLM gateway with cross-provider failover, circuit breakers, rate limits and an exact-match response cache.

Deciding what goes to an agent, to code, or to a person

- Map each workflow with the people who run it, then decide which steps an agent takes, which steps code takes, and where a person approves.
- Every agent hands off to a person with a reason code and the transcript. In evaluation, a correct handoff scores as a pass and an unneeded one as a miss.
- The agent tells "the answer was not found" apart from "the business has not decided this," so policy gaps go to the owner and are never guessed.

Measurement and governance

- Release gates: a 103-scenario live evaluation with an answer-rate floor of 0.8 that is never lowered without a written reason, and a CI gate that fails the build when LLM or RAG output regresses and refuses to accept an empty baseline.
- Decision-support tools leave the decision with a person: in my compliance tools, a model may add a reviewer note but cannot change a verdict.
- Kept outputs of a model whose license excludes the United States out of every published or client-facing work product.
- Check every public claim against the code before it ships, and remove any claim that no measurement supports.

Running AI agents as a team

- Direct up to 17 concurrent AI agent sessions with shared written rules, a memory system, review hooks, and a gate that checks every paid generation job against an approved tool list before it runs.

Founder and Operator, small businesses

- Premium grooming brand, direct to consumer: formulation, small-batch manufacturing, packaging, marketing, fulfillment and customer service, with full profit-and-loss responsibility.
- Fuel-delivery operations platform: designed the franchise economics (royalty, brand fee, per-vehicle technology lease) and a nine-role operating platform with a public demo. Pre-launch.
- Investigations practice: research, surveillance, case management, evidence handling and client reporting.
- CDL training site with every lesson tied to the regulation it comes from.

Freight Operations: Supervisor and Company-Certified Driver Trainer

- Supervised and trained drivers, with authority to sign off new operators to drive unsupervised.
- Currently a line-haul driver at Old Dominion Freight Line. Class A CDL with hazmat, tanker and triples endorsements, in an operation run on dispatch and federal hours-of-service limits.

SYSTEMS I BUILT

Production customer-service agent (live, private repo): tool-grounded pricing, output guards, reason-coded handoffs, 103-scenario live evaluation, calibrated low-cost judge model · **Release gate for LLM and RAG output** · **Agent loop with cost and step ceilings** and a six-class failure taxonomy · **LLM gateway with provider failover** · **Grounded support assistant** that rejects any answer citing a passage it was not given · **Policy-control evidence review** · local voice assistant that skips the model when a stored answer fits

SKILLS

AI operations	AI spend and token usage analysis, cost per result, model selection, ROI reporting, adoption, workflow mapping, vendor and pricing models
Agents in production	Agentic AI, tool calling, Model Context Protocol (MCP), human-in-the-loop handoff, escalation, guardrails, kill switches
Evaluation and governance	Evals, regression gates in CI, calibrated LLM judges, RAG metrics, audit trails, license and data controls
Efficiency	Model routing, provider failover, response caching, prompt-cache use, local open models (Ollama, Qwen), cost and step ceilings
Engineering	Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Next.js, Postgres, SQLite, Docker, Vercel, GitHub Actions, Claude, OpenAI-compatible APIs, Claude Code

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Capella University, Master of Business Administration (in progress) | **Capella University**, B.S. Computer Science, GPA 3.95

Anthropic teaching certificate, Teaching the AI Fluency Framework, plus Anthropic Academy courses on Claude Code, MCP, and enterprise deployment on Bedrock and Vertex AI | **IBM**, AI Product Manager Professional Certificate | **DeepLearning.AI**, Generative AI with LLMs

"Reference-Relative Believability", independent research paper on evaluating AI-generated media, archived on Zenodo. DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21138188